[METRIC]
A-A-162A
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SUPERCEDES
A-A-162
April 20, 1981

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CLOTH, CLEANING (NONWOVEN)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. This commercial item description (CID) covers nonwoven wiping cloths.

2. CLASSIFICATION. The cloths shall be the following types and classes:

Type I - Untreated
Class 1 - Light duty.
Class 2 - Heavy duty.
Type II - Treated

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

3.1 Type I. The type I cloths shall consist of nonwoven cellulosic material adhered into a planer assembly meeting the characteristics of table I. The finished cloths shall be suitable for use as a cloth for wiping up grease and liquid spills.

3.2 Type II. The type II cloths shall consist of nonwoven cellulosic material adhered into a planer assembly meeting the characteristics of table II. The finished cloth shall be treated for soil pickup with a non-toxic treatment that will not evaporate or otherwise deteriorate, or cause damage to the shipping materials. The finished cloth shall be suitable for use as a dust cloth by itself and in conjunction with a floor mop meeting the requirements of NSN 7920-00-782-3784.

Table I, Physical characteristics of the type I cloths.

Characteristic	Class 1	Class 2	Test Method
Size (minimum)	967 cm^2	40.0 x 60.0 cm	Visual
Tensile strength (N/m, minimum)	0.135	0.452	TAPPI T494
Grammage (g/m^2, minimum)	42.0	72.0	TAPPI T410
Water Absorbency Capacity (% by weight, minimum)	400	400	para. 3.3
Water Absorbency Rate (sec., maximum)	10	10	TAPPI T432
Oil Absorbency Capacity (% by weight, minimum)	350	350	para. 3.3
Oil Absorbency Rate (sec., minimum)	35	35	TAPPI T432 \1

\1 Use light mineral oil, viscosity 80-90 SU (Saybolt Universal) instead of water.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: General Services Administration, Engineering Group (7FXEE), 819 Taylor Street, Fort Worth, TX 76102

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FSC 7920

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Table II, Physical characteristics of the type II cloths.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method
Size (minimum)	40.0 x 55.0 cm	Visual
Tensile strength (N/m, minimum)	0.135	TAPPI T494
Dry grammage (g/m^2, minimum)	42.0	TAPPI T410

3.3 Absorbency. The type I cloths shall have the absorbency capacity required by table I. The test for this shall be as follows:

3.3.1 Water. Cut specimens (10 cm x 10 cm is recommended) and weight to nearest 0.1 g. Entirely immerse each sample in distilled water at 25 degrees Centigrade for 3 minutes without movement. Remove by lifting at one corner until entire specimen is clear of the water, allow excess water to drain off for 60 seconds. Place each in a tared weighing bottle and reweigh. Calculate the percent absorption to the nearest 1 percent as follows:

Percent absorption =
[(Wet weight - dry weight)/ dry weight] x 100

3.3.2 Oil. Same as 3.3.1 using white mineral oil, viscosity 80-90 SU (Saybolt Universal), in lieu of water. Drain time shall be 20 minutes.

3.4 Workmanship. The cloths shall be free from holes, tears, dirt, spots, ragged or uneven edges, or any other defects that affect serviceability.

3.5 Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within tolerances specified and all other requirements of this document are met.

3.8 Commercial item. The use of the term "commercial item description" in this document does not imply that any item or items offered are not required to conform with all requirements specified herein.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

5.1 General quality statement. The products provided shall conform to the requirements of this commercial item description, and the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

6. PACKAGING, PACKING AND MARKING

6.1 Packaging, packing and marking. The packaging, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. NOTES

7.1 Intended use. The cloths described by this CID are intended for general cleaning use.

7.2 Ordering data. Purchases should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

a. Title, number, and date of this CID.
b. Type and class.
c. The packaging, packing and marking desired

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7.3 Part Identification Number (PIN). This part numbering system is intended for identification and cross-indexing of the item by the government only and does not constitute a requirement for the contractor.

Example: AA162-1 A

- A = Class 1, B = Class 2
- 1 = Type I, 2 = Type II
- CID A-A-162

7.4 National Stock Numbers. The following NSNs (with the appropriate part number) are known to use this document:

NSN	Part Number
7920-00-292-9204	1A
7920-00-401-8034	1B
7920-00-782-3779	2

7.5 Referenced documents.

TAPPI

T410 Grammage of Paper and Paperboard (Weight Per Unit Area)

T432 Water Absorbency of Bibulous Paper

T494 Tensile Breaking Properties of Paper and Paperboard (Using Constant Rate of Elongation Apparatus)

TAPPI documents are available from TAPPI, 15 Technology Parkway South, Norcross, GA 30092, (404) 446-1400.

Preparing Activity:
GSA - FSS

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